



Staff Report

TO: Honorable Mayor and Members of the City Council
FROM: Robert L. Vestal, Public Works Director | City Engineer
BY: Vincent Lopez, Project Manager
DATE: August 4, 2026
SUBJECT: Public Hearing to Adopt a Mitigated Negative Declaration for the Beaumont Transit Yard Project – Capital Improvement Project No. T25-01 in compliance with the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) and National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA)

Description: Adopt a Mitigated Negative Declaration and Mitigated and Monitoring Reporting Program for the Beaumont Transit Yard located on the southwest corner of 4th Street and Veile Avenue based on a completed Initial Study in compliance with CEQA and NEPA.

Motion:

If the City Council determines that staff's recommendation is appropriate, the following motion is provided:

I move to adopt a Mitigated Negative Declaration and Mitigated and Monitoring Reporting Program for the Beaumont Transit Yard Project.

Recommendation:

The recommendation is to adopt the Mitigated Negative Declaration and the Mitigation and Monitoring Reporting Program for the Beaumont Transit Yard, ensuring the project proceeds with all required environmental safeguards. The project will construct a new transit yard at the intersection of 4th Street and Viele, including an administration building, maintenance garage, and hydrogen and CNG fueling facilities. The CEQA and NEPA review determined that the project will not result in significant environmental impacts with the implementation of required mitigation measures related to biological, cultural, and geological resources. The Draft IS/MND was circulated for public review and received comments from AQMD. Those comments have been addressed in the final IS/MND.

Discussion:

Project Background and Description

On July 16, 2024, the City Council awarded a Professional Services Agreement (PSA) to Gillis + Panichapan Architects, Inc. (GPa) for Architecture and Engineering Design Services of the Beaumont Transit Yard (Project). The scope of services includes the development of a full set of plans, specifications, and estimates ready for construction bidding, as well as bidding and construction support services. This scope of services also includes the preparation of the draft and final CEQA Initial Study/Mitigated Negative Declaration (IS/MND). Since the City has been actively pursuing external funding to help offset capital project costs, the analysis and preparation of the NEPA documentation is also included.

The proposed Project is located at the southwest intersection of 4th Street and Veile Avenue within the City of Beaumont, California. The Project would develop a Transit Yard and facility utilized by the City for operational purposes (Figure 1). The approximately 6.15-acre, City-owned parcel would include the construction of the following facilities:

- Administration Building (9,982 S.F.)
- Fleet Maintenance Garage (11,250 S.F.)
- Solar Canopies (10,600 S.F.)
- 8 Hydrogen Fueling Stations
- 15 Compressed Natural Gas (CNG) Fueling Stations
- Electric Vehicle (EV) Charging Infrastructure
- Designated Parking (uncovered and solar covered) up to 200 spaces.



Figure 1 – Site Rendering

The Project site would accommodate up to 100 occupants under the current project design, although occupancy levels could vary in the future depending on operational needs and building use.

The Administration Building and a solar canopy approximately 2,980 square feet in size would be developed on the northeastern corner of the Project site. The eastern side of the Project site would consist of 55 parking spaces designated for administrative staff, bus drivers, future staff, and fleet maintenance personnel. This area would incorporate six (6) electric vehicle (EV) charging spaces and three (3) accessible spaces.

Initial Study / Mitigated Negative Declaration:

The proposed Project requires compliance with the guidelines and regulations of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA). An Initial Study (IS) was prepared resulting in a Mitigated Negative Declaration (MND), which addresses the direct, indirect, and cumulative environmental effects associated with the proposed Project.

The Final Initial Study / Mitigated Negative Declaration is included as Attachment A to this staff report. This IS/MND has been prepared in conformance with the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Section 21091 and State CEQA Guidelines Section 15073 and the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) guidelines.

The IS/MND has determined that the proposed project would not have any significant impact on the environment once all the proposed mitigation measures have been implemented. The proposed mitigation measures are summarized in the Mitigation Monitoring and Reporting Program (MMRP) attached to this staff report (Attachment A). These Mitigations include the following:

- Biological Resources:
 - Pre-Construction Nesting Bird Surveys
 - Pre-Construction Burrowing Owl Surveys
 - Regulatory Permitting
- Cultural Resources:
 - Archaeological Monitoring
 - Tribal Monitoring (Morongo Band of Mission Indians)
- Geology and Soils:
 - Paleontological Monitoring

The draft IS/MND was circulated to the public and public agencies for a 30-day public review from June 15, 2026, through July 14, 2026. Notice of the public review period and availability of the Initial Study/Mitigated Negative Declaration was also published in the Press-Enterprise newspaper.

The proof of publication is included as Attachment D to this Staff Report. During the public commenting period, the Public Works Department received comments and a technical data request from the South Coast Air Quality Management District (SCAQMD). The Chambers Group responded to this request. Any comments and recommendations have been incorporated into the Final MND.

No other comments from the public in favor of or in opposition to the project were received. The proof of publication for the Public Hearing is also included as Attachment E to this Staff Report. Any comments received prior to the time of the scheduled City Council meeting will be provided at the time of the public hearing.

The draft IS/MND circulated for public review is provided as Attachment C to this staff report, with copies of all technical studies performed. These technical studies include the following:

- Air Quality Assessment
- Cultural Resources Study
- Global Climate Change
- Noise Assessment
- Trip Generation Memorandum

- Vehicle Miles Traveled (VMT) Analysis
- Site Distance and Swept Path Analysis

Upon adoption of the IS/MND a Notice of Determination (NOD) will be filed with Riverside County and the State Clearing House. A copy of the NOD has been provided with this staff report as Attachment B. The Final IS/MND, MMRP, draft IS/MND circulated to the public, and NOD constitute the final Mitigated Negative Declaration for the Beaumont Transit Yard Project.

Fiscal Impact:

The recommended action will not have a fiscal impact on the project budget. This project is being funded by a variety of grants that include the following:

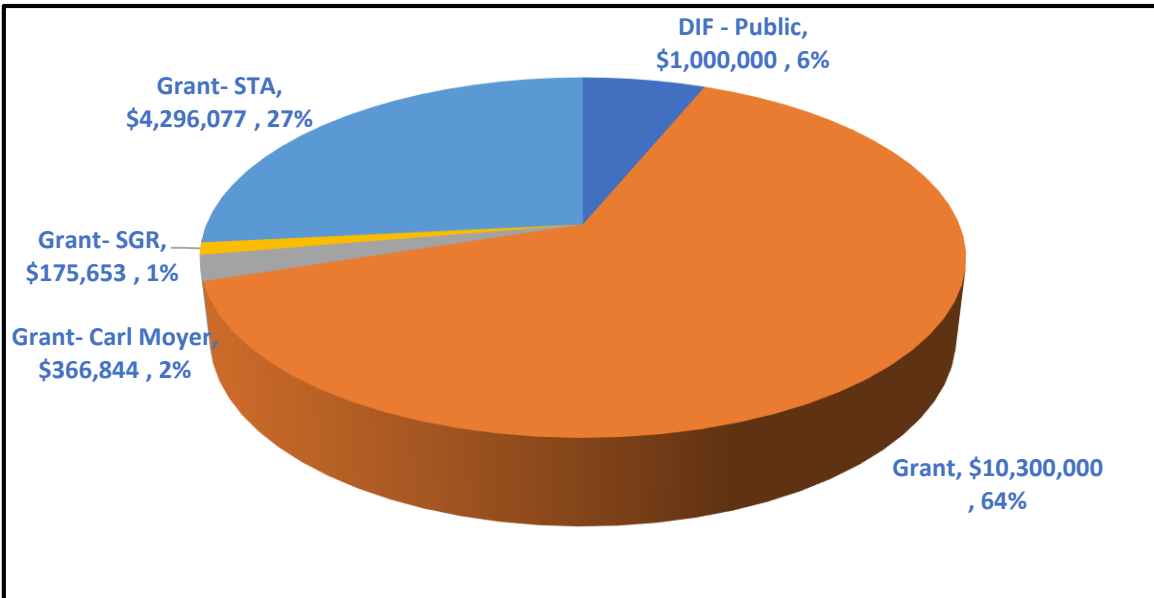
Fiscal Year	Funding or Grant Program	Funding Committed
20/21	SCAQMD Carl Moyer	\$366,844
22/23	Senate Bill 1 State of Good Repair (SGR)	\$175,653
22/23	State Transit Assistance (STA)	\$3,275,239
25/26	State Transit Assistance (STA)	\$1,020,838
24/25	Senate Bill 125 Transit and Intercity Rail Capital Program (TIRCP)	\$10,300,000
26/27	DIF – Public Facilities	\$1,000,000
Total:		\$16,138,574

The following is a summary table for the Project's budget and funding:

CIP T25-01 Beaumont City & Transit Yard Project Funding Summary

Estimated Total Project Budget = \$16,138,574

Current Project Budget= \$16,138,574



CIP T25-01 Beaumont City & Transit Yard Project Budget Summary

Project Component	Est. Total Budget	Current Budget	Paid to Date	Remaining Budget
Project Management				
Preliminary Services				
Environmental				
Design	\$220,000	\$220,000		\$220,000
Permits				
Right-of-Way				
Construction	\$15,918,574	\$15,918,574		\$15,918,574
Construction Management				
Equipment				
Total	\$16,138,574	\$16,138,574	\$-	\$16,138,574

Alternatives:

N/A

Attachments:

- A. Final MND and MMRP
- B. Notice of Determination (NOD)

- C. Draft IS/MND
- D. Proof of Publication – IS/MND
- E. Proof of Publication – Public Hearing